

48-Hour Validation Sprint: Quick Reference Guide

Pre-Sprint Checklist (Do 1 Week Before)

- ✓ Clear your calendar - block entire weekend
- ✓ Set up accounts:
 - Landing page tool (Carrd \$19/year)
 - Google Analytics (free)
 - Email capture (ConvertKit free tier)
 - Google Ads (\$50 budget loaded)
 - Domain name purchased ✓ Identify 3 subreddits, 3 Facebook groups, 2 Slack communities ✓ Write 3-4 headline variations to test ✓ Budget: \$50-100 set aside

Hour-by-Hour Sprint Schedule

FRIDAY - Day 1

Hours 0-2: Landing Page Copy

- Headline (10 words max, benefit-focused)
- Subheadline (expand on promise)
- 3 key benefits (not features!)
- How it works (3 simple steps)
- Social proof elements
- Clear CTA button text
- Urgency element

Hours 2-4: Visual Assets

- Create product mockup (Figma/Canva/AI)
- Design simple logo
- Take screenshots if building functional prototype

Hours 4-8: Build Landing Page

- Option A: Carrd.co template (2-3 hours)
- Option B: Code simple HTML page (4 hours)

- Connect email capture form
- Add Google Analytics
- Test mobile view

Hours 8-12: Traffic Preparation

- Set up Google Ads (5-10 keywords, \$10-15/day budget)
- Write Twitter post + mockup image
- Write LinkedIn post (professional tone)
- Write 3 Reddit posts (authentic, helpful)
- Draft Facebook group posts
- Prepare email to 10-20 target users

Hours 12-16: LAUNCH

- 12:00 PM: Final page review
- 12:15 PM: Publish landing page
- 12:30 PM: Activate Google Ads
- 1:00 PM: Tweet with mockup
- 1:15 PM: LinkedIn post
- 2:00 PM: First Facebook group
- 2:30 PM: First subreddit
- 3:00 PM: Slack communities
- 3:30 PM: Second subreddit
- 4:00 PM: Send personal emails

Hours 16-20: Engage & Respond

- Monitor all channels every 15 minutes
- Respond to every comment/question
- Screenshot interesting feedback
- Note common objections
- Track which posts get best engagement

Hours 20-24: Optimize

- Check metrics: visitors, signups, conversion rate, CPC
- If conversion < 5%, test new headline
- If CPC > \$3, adjust keyword targeting
- Identify best-performing channel
- Schedule Day 2 interviews

SATURDAY - Day 2

Hours 24-30: User Interviews

- Email all signups offering \$25 gift card for 15-min call
- Schedule interviews throughout the day
- Ask 6 key questions:
 1. Why did you sign up?
 2. What problem does this solve for you?
 3. What do you use today?
 4. What would make this must-have?
 5. How much would you pay monthly?
 6. Would you pay \$15/month today?
- Record calls (with permission)
- Take detailed notes

Hours 30-36: Financial Analysis Calculate these metrics:

1. **CAC** = Total Ad Spend ÷ Signups
2. **Conversion Rate** = (Signups ÷ Visitors) × 100
3. **Channel Performance** - Which sources converted best?
4. **Revenue Projection** = Signups × 30% × \$15/mo × 12
5. **LTV:CAC Ratio** = (\$15 × 12) ÷ CAC

Hours 36-40: Decision Preparation

- Compile all data
- Score against 6 criteria

- Review interview notes for patterns
- Calculate market size (if not done pre-sprint)
- Prepare recommendation

Hours 40-48: Go/No-Go Decision Score these 6 criteria (Pass/Fail):

1. ☒ Landing page conversion > 10%
2. ☒ Email signups > 30
3. ☒ Payment intent > 5 people
4. ☒ CAC < \$10
5. ☒ Market size (SOM) > \$100K Year 1
6. ☒ Clear competitive advantage

Results:

- **4-6 Passed:** GO - Start building immediately
- **2-3 Passed:** PIVOT - Change one major thing, retest
- **0-1 Passed:** STOP - Document learnings, move to next idea

Key Templates

Landing Page Headline Formula

"[Action Verb] [Desired Outcome] in [Timeframe]"

Example: "Create Professional Invoices in 30 Seconds"

Reddit Post Template

Title: Built [tool] after getting frustrated with [problem]. Looking for feedback.

Post: Hey everyone, I'm a [profession] who got tired of [specific pain point].

I built a simple tool that [core benefit]. You can [feature 1], [feature 2], and [feature 3].

I'm looking for beta testers to try it out and give honest feedback. If interested, grab early access here: [link]

Not trying to sell anything—genuinely want feedback from people who deal with this regularly.

Happy to answer questions!

Interview Email Template

Subject: Quick question about [Product Name] (+ \$25 Amazon gift card)

Hi [Name],

Thanks for joining the [Product] waitlist! I'm trying to make sure I'm building something people actually want.

Would you be willing to jump on a 15-minute call to share your thoughts? I'll send you a \$25 Amazon gift card as thanks for your time.

If interested, grab a time here: [Calendly link]

No pressure if you're not interested—either way, I'll keep you updated on launch.

Thanks!

[Your name]

Success Metrics

"Excellent" Validation Signals

- Landing page conversion: >10%
- Email signups: >100
- User interviews: >10 completed
- Willing to pay: >30% of interviewees
- CAC: <\$5
- LTV:CAC ratio: >20:1
- Social media engagement: High comments/shares
- Organic signups: >50% of total

"Good" Validation Signals

- Landing page conversion: 5-10%
- Email signups: 30-100
- User interviews: 5-10 completed
- Willing to pay: 10-30% of interviewees
- CAC: \$5-10

- LTV:CAC ratio: 10:1-20:1
- Social media engagement: Moderate
- Organic signups: 25-50% of total

"Weak" Validation Signals (Pivot or Stop)

- Landing page conversion: <5%
- Email signups: <30
- User interviews: <5 completed
- Willing to pay: <10% of interviewees
- CAC: >\$10
- LTV:CAC ratio: <10:1
- Social media engagement: Low/none
- Organic signups: <25% of total

Common Mistakes to Avoid

✗ Building before validating - Sprint comes BEFORE development **✗ Perfectionism** - Good enough beats perfect in 48 hours **✗ Ignoring negative feedback** - Criticism is the most valuable data **✗ Rationalizing weak signals** - Trust the data, not your emotions **✗ Posting everywhere at once** - Stagger posts to monitor engagement **✗ Not interviewing signups** - Signups without willingness to pay = false positive **✗ Skipping financial analysis** - You need to know CAC and LTV:CAC **✗ Making go decision without data** - All 6 criteria matter

Post-Sprint Actions

If GO:

1. Start building MVP immediately (Module 3)
2. Keep landing page live
3. Email waitlist weekly with updates
4. Set 14-30 day launch deadline
5. Begin content creation for launch

If PIVOT:

1. Identify weakest 1-2 criteria
2. Hypothesize specific change to address them

3. Make ONE major change only
4. Run second 48-hour sprint
5. Limit to 2 pivots maximum

If STOP:

1. Document all learnings
2. Thank participants
3. Archive/repurpose landing page
4. Return to Module 1 idea selection
5. Apply learnings to next idea

Tools & Resources

Free/Cheap Tools

- **Landing Page:** Carrd (\$19/year), Webflow (free tier)
- **Email:** ConvertKit (free <1000), Mailchimp (free <500)
- **Analytics:** Google Analytics (free)
- **Mockups:** Figma (free), Canva (\$13/month)
- **Ads:** Google Ads (\$50 minimum)
- **Domain:** Namecheap (\$12/year)
- **Scheduling:** Calendly (free)
- **Transcription:** Otter.ai (free tier)

AI Acceleration Tools

- **Copy:** ChatGPT, Claude, Copy.ai
- **Images:** Midjourney (\$10/month), DALL-E (pay-per-use)
- **Analysis:** ChatGPT Advanced Data Analysis
- **Research:** Perplexity AI

Remember:

"The goal isn't to build a perfect landing page. The goal is to generate enough data to make an informed decision about whether this idea deserves 3 months of your life."

Speed over perfection. Data over intuition. Action over analysis paralysis.

You've got this. Now go validate! 🚀